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Muddy Ruel, onetime Washington catcher, had this to say the other day:

"In the long haul, bonus money spent for signing young players would be better invested in catchers than in pitchers, as is being done. But when boys are at the bonus signing age, say just out of high school, the potentially great catcher hasn't developed to the point where he's recognized. There's no sure easy way for him to prove himself a future star. All the young pitcher has to do is strike out a lot of batters. So, it's not that the clubs are unwilling to gamble on the young catcher; it's just that the scouts haven't discovered him."

Paul Chervinko, onetime University of Illinois captain and manager-catcher for the Danville III club, is piloting the Danville Boosters.

Several weeks ago the team, featuring Steve Kelly, Danville High school star, bested Lee Eilbracht's Illinoisans 3-2.

Danville city officials and Andy Cohen, a live wire baseball man, are keeping the Danville Stadium, now owned by the city, in shape with the hopes league ball will come back in a year or so.

Jim Swickard, sports editor of the Galesburg Mail, has returned from an Eastern trip and noticed quite a difference in road signs.

In 1938 most every inn had a sign, "George Washington Slept Here."

That sign has, in many cases, been changed to, "Ike Putted Here."